

GENDER



BENDERS

Ganesh Subramanian vs. Aakanksha Kekan

Tag An Mp3



40 sec

A second year BSc (IT) student, Ganesh is raring to go. A music file titled Beatles appears in the Winamp playlist. He right-clicks the filename and the dialog box 'MPEG file info box + ID3 tag editor' appears. Straightaway, Ganesh clicks the ID3v1 tag icon and merrily enters the information we provided in the 'Title', 'Artist', 'Album', 'Year', 'Genre' and 'Comment' sections. He grins widely at us—having tagged the mp3 effortlessly, well almost, and in good time.



2 min 10 sec

Aakanksha is pursuing her BE (IT). Though tech-savvy, she needs some mollycoddling to get rid of her apprehensions. Aakanksha narrows her eyes at Winamp and selects the Beatles song. She fumbles about with the various options, clicking this and that, and sighs. Finally, she clicks the 'Misc' button that appears in the last row of the Winamp playlist, opens 'File Info', and the right dialog box appears. Aakanksha quickly enters the data and appears visibly relieved.

Epson is the leader in the Japanese market but not so in the rest of the markets. Commenting on the same, Niwa further explained, "We have laid greater emphasis on photo printing in Japan and therefore enjoy the marketshare we have. We have a different strategy for every market."

Also unveiled on the occasion were a range of new printers that used pigment inks for improved print quality, and a wider

range of applications. Using special inks and media, inkjet printing could even facilitate the printing of electronics and household items in the near future.

While some of the innovative applications do sound far-fetched, they could be practical pretty soon. So don't be surprised if you see someone printing their own ties and even PCBs at home! *(The author was hosted by Seiko Epson in Japan)*

BULLISH ABOUT INDIA

FICCI Frames

The annual FICCI-Frames conference on the 'Business of Entertainment' was held in Mumbai, from April 4 to April 6. A conference where the gurus of the entertainment world met, saw a few policy statements by the Information & Broadcasting Minister, Jaipal Reddy.

With the increasing demand for radio to be freed from the licensing structure the minister made a commitment to set up guidelines to enable almost 300 private radio stations in the country in a years time.

Coupled with this, he also emphasised the need to push for the popularising of the community radio. The government, he said, was keen to see as many as 4,000 community radio stations come up around the country. In addition to these he also spoke of considering the revenue sharing model instead of the present annual licensing one to boost the sector.

The other major areas under the spotlight were piracy and IPR and the emergence of mobile gaming, entertainment and news.

All the industry experts and leaders were bullish about entering the Indian market in the mobile and animation area. Gaming major EA said that they were evaluating the Indian market and would be entering the mobile gaming sector very soon.

EA Asia President Jon Nierman also said that India was a very attractive

proposition for the development of games, as it has a technically strong talent pool.

Among other international companies TOM Online, the parent company of Indiagames.com, said that they were keen to increase their presence in India by providing more interactive and user-specific content for mobile phones. "We are very positive on India, because at 36 per cent, it has the highest 5-year CAGR in terms of cell phone growth," said S Wang, CEO & ED, TOM Online.

The animation and movie special effects area was also a prime focus area, with the number of co-productions increasing and the use of new technologies such as Digital Integration in Bollywood movies.

With the mood positive at the conference, one thought voiced constantly: it's time India replicated the software success story in entertainment.

MONITORING OF RESOURCES

ISRO To Link All Tamil Nadu Villages

India's premier space Agency, ISRO, plans to create resource centres linked by satellites in all villages of Tamil Nadu. The resource centres are based in Rameswaram, Dindigul and Thiruvaiyaru districts. The M S Swaminathan Foundation, based in Chennai, will be the nodal agency.

The centres will monitor

LightScribe

HP recently announced a new disk-labelling technology called LightScribe, which lets you burn high-quality labels onto specially-coated CDs and DVDs. Apart from special media, you require LightScribe-capable CD or DVD Writers and compatible software in order to use the new labelling system. To label a compatible disk using

LightScribe, you just burn it the way you normally do, and then flip it over in the drive tray to burn text and/or graphics. LightScribe technology currently supports only greyscale printing at 1x speeds. However, the future promises higher speeds and colour support. You can visit www.LightScribe.com for further details.

Buzzword
of the MONTH